MISR LANGUAGE SCHOOLS
National Primary Stage

Grade 6

Wonders

Fiction



Name: _____

Class: _____

2026-2027
First Term

MISR LANGUAGE SCHOOLS National Primary Stage

English Language Arts

Primary VI

Wonders

Fiction Booklet

School Year

2026/2027

Name: _____

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Literary genres



each is read differently because they are written for different **purposes**, & are **organized** differently

FICTION

Purpose

To entertain with a story

When we read **FICTION** we look for..

- ...main character
- ...goals
- ...problem
- solution
- outcome

NON-FICTION

Purpose

To inform or explain real life

When we read **NON-FICTION** we look for..

- ...features
- ...main ideas
- ...important information
- ...organization

POETRY

Purpose

To entertain with feelings & senses

When we read **POETRY** we look for..

- ...form
- ...speaker
- ...topic
- emotions
- message

DRAMA

Purpose

comedy or tragedy

When we read **DRAMA** we look for..

- ...dialogue
- ...characters
- ...performance
- ...staging
- ...audience

FICTION sub genres

Fantasy · Mystery/Thriller · Science Fiction · Horror · Romance · Western

We put it all together to MAKE MEANING!!!

Fiction

Examples of Fiction Genres:

1. **Realistic Fiction:**

   stories that could happen in real life, with believable characters and events

2. **Fantasy:**

   stories set in imaginary worlds with magical creatures, powers, or supernatural events

3. **Folktale:**

   traditional stories passed down orally, often teaching a lesson or explaining a custom

4. **Myth:**

   ancient stories that explain natural events, gods, or the origins of the world

5. **Science Fiction:**

   stories based on advanced science or technology, often set in the future or space

6. **Historical Fiction:**

   stories set in the past with fictional characters but real historical settings or events

7. **Fairy Tale:**

   magical stories for children that often include royalty, talking animals, and happy endings

8. **Tall Tale:**

   exaggerated, humorous stories about larger-than-life characters with unbelievable deeds

Figures of Speech

Figurative language is a powerful tool used in literature and everyday communication to add color, depth, and impact to our words. Instead of using words literally, figurative language employs figures of speech to create imagery, evoke emotions, express complex ideas simply, make language more creative and interesting, and make comparisons.

1. Simile

A simile is a direct comparison between two unlike things using the words "like" or "as." It highlights a similarity between the two things being compared.

"Her smile was as bright as the sun."

2. Metaphor

A metaphor is a direct comparison between two unlike things without using "like" or "as." It states that one thing is another, implying a deeper connection or shared quality.

"The classroom was a zoo after the teacher left."

3. Personification

Personification is giving human qualities, characteristics, or actions to inanimate objects, animals, or abstract ideas.

"The wind whispered secrets through the trees."

4. Hyperbole

Hyperbole is an extreme exaggeration used for emphasis or effect, not meant to be taken literally. It creates a strong impression and can be humorous.

"I'm so hungry I could eat a horse."

5. Alliteration

Alliteration is the repetition of the same beginning consonant sound in words that are close together. It is often used for poetic effect or to create a particular rhythm.

"**P**eter **P**iper **p**icked a **p**eck of **p**ickled **p**eppers."

“The **sh**y **sh**eep **sh**uffled silently through the **sh**ady **sh**ed.”

“The **cl**ever **cl**own **cl**apped loudly and **cl**imbed the curtain.”

6. Onomatopoeia

Onomatopoeia is the formation of a word from a sound associated with what is named (e.g., cuckoo, sizzle). These words imitate the sounds they represent.

- "The bacon **sizzled** in the pan while the cat meowed loudly."
- “The clock **ticked** steadily on the wall.”

- “The fire **crackled** as the logs burned.”
- “The car **screeched** to a sudden stop.”

7. Idiom

An idiom is a phrase or expression whose meaning cannot be understood from the ordinary meaning of its individual words. Its meaning is culturally specific and often figurative.

"He's feeling under the weather." (meaning he's feeling sick)

8. Imagery

Imagery is the use of vivid and descriptive language that appeals to one or more of the five senses (sight, sound, smell, taste, touch) to create a mental picture for the reader. While not a single "figure of speech" in the same way as simile or metaphor, it's a broad category of figurative language.

"The crisp, cool air bit at her exposed skin, carrying the sweet scent of pine needles and the faint sound of rustling leaves."

9. Oxymoron

An oxymoron is a figure of speech in which apparently contradictory terms appear in conjunction. It combines two words with opposite meanings to create a surprising or thought-provoking effect.

- As the teacher entered the room, a **deafening silence** fell over the students.
  “Deafening silence” emphasizes how intense and heavy the quietness was.
- A **small crowd** gathered to watch the show.
  “Small crowd” emphasizes the presence of a few people, but still called a crowd.
- She let out a silent scream when the door creaked open.
  “Silent scream” shows intense emotions (expressing fear or shock) without sounds

Ex: pretty ugly, original copy, act naturally, clearly confused, bittersweet

Understanding and utilizing these different types of figurative language can significantly enhance writing and communication, making it more engaging, memorable, and impactful.

Start Smart

Unit 0 Week 1
The Cricket and the Jaguar

Essential Question:
What discoveries can people make when they cooperate with others?

The Cricket and the Jaguar

A folktale from Argentina



In the heat of the bright noon sun, tiny Cricket was so happy he couldn't stop himself from chirping. Unfortunately, Bossy Jaguar was trying to take a nap nearby.

"Hey, you puny little pest," shouted Jaguar at the tiny insect, "stop chirping right now! It's annoying and I'm trying to sleep."

"I don't mean to annoy you," said Cricket, "but the sun is so warm; it makes me want to sing."

"Well, cut it out," growled the cranky cat. "Don't you see how much bigger I am than you?" To make his point, the jaguar opened his mouth as wide as possible, baring his shiny, sharp teeth.

"I'll see what I can do," answered Cricket.

Jaguar trotted away smugly, curled up, and drifted off to sleep. But the hot desert sun kept on shining, and Cricket felt so warm and content that he couldn't resist the temptation to sign out. He chirped a jolly chirp, and Jaguar woke up with a snarl.

"You have one more chance to be quiet. If you are not, I'll put an end to your annoying happy song once and for all!" Jaguar once again showed his fearsome teeth. But this time, he also raised the hair on his back, which made him look even bigger and more ferocious.

"I'll do my best," said Cricket.

Satisfied with his impressive display, Jaguar curled up once more and drifted off to sleep. But the desert sun kept shining, and Cricket felt too happy to stay quiet, so he chirped a loud, cheerful chirp.



"That's it!" roared Jaguar. "I declare war on all crickets!" Jaguar called together the pumas, boars, and armadillos and prepared to stamp out all annoying insects.

But Cricket called together the bees, wasps, and stinging ants and told them about Jaguar's threats. They all agreed to help fight back.

The battle was short and sweet for the insects. Painfully stung, all of Jaguar's allies ran away. Jaguar stood alone on the battlefield, crying from the sharp stings.

"You see," whispered Cricket into one of Jaguar's swollen, bee-stung ears, "there is no such thing as a small enemy."

Jaguar slunk off to wait for his swelling to go down. Cricket returned to saluting the bright sun with his joyful, triumphant chirping.

Directions: Answer the following questions after reading the folktale.

1. **How did the setting "In the bright noon sun" cause the conflict between Cricket and Jaguar?**
   The bright noon sun made Cricket feel warm and happy, so he wanted to chirp. Jaguar was trying to sleep, so Cricket's singing caused the conflict between them.

2. **What details indicate that Jaguar thinks his size is enough to make Cricket stop singing? Cite text evidence.**
   He opens his mouth wide to show his "shiny, sharp teeth" and raises the hair on his back to look even bigger and more frightening. He says, "Don't you see how much bigger I am than you?"

3. **Read the following excerpt.**
   "But the hot desert sun kept on shining, and Cricket felt so warm and **content** that he couldn't resist the temptation to sign out. He chirped a jolly chirp, and Jaguar woke up with a snarl."
   What is a synonym for "content"?
   a. sad b. nervous c. happy d. angry

4. **A. What kind of character is Jaguar based on lines 5-16?**
   Jaguar is bossy, arrogant, and threatening.

   B. What does Cricket's reaction tell us about him?
   Cricket's reaction shows that he is cheerful, confident, and not easily intimidated.

5. **A. What was the reason Jaguar reached his climatic point and declared "war on all crickets"?**
   The reason is that Cricket continued chirping even after Jaguar had warned him several times.

   B. How could the climax have been avoided?
   The climax could have been avoided if Jaguar had calmly asked Cricket to move somewhere else instead of threatening him.

6. **What does it mean when the passage says the battle was "short and sweet for the insects"? How is that an example of figurative language?**

   "Short and sweet for the insects" means that the insects won the battle quickly and easily. It is figurative language because the battle was not literally "sweet"; the phrase means the result was very favorable for the insects.

7. **What do Jaguar's actions after the battle tell you about how his view of himself has changed? (Refer to lines 30 to 37)**

Jaguar realizes that he is not as powerful as he thought. After being defeated and stung, he leaves alone and waits for his swelling to go down.

8. **Read the following excerpt.**

"Painfully stung, all of Jaguar's **allies** ran away. Jaguar stood alone on the battlefield, crying from the sharp stings."

What is an <u>antonym</u> for "allies"?

a. supporters b. friends c. helpers d. enemies

9. **Read the following excerpt.**

"Jaguar <u>slunk off</u> to wait for his swelling to go down."

A. What do the phrase "<u>slunk off</u>" and the word "swelling" tell us about how Jaguar was feeling and acting?

"Slunk off" shows that Jaguar left quietly and sadly, while "swelling" shows that he was hurt from the insects' stings.

B. How does this phrase show that Jaguar isn't as powerful as he pretends to be?

It shows that Jaguar is not as powerful as he pretends because the tiny insects defeated him and forced him to leave the battlefield.

10. **How might the story have been different if Jaguar had responded kindly to Cricket from the beginning?**

There would have been no battle. Cricket could have kept chirping happily, and Jaguar could have rested peacefully. Both animals might even have become friends instead of enemies.

11. **Infer the main theme and cite text evidence in support.**

Size does not determine strength, and no enemy is too small to matter. Text evidence: "There is no such thing as a small enemy."

12. **Which character does the narrator favour? Cite text evidence.**

He favours Cricket. Text evidence: Cricket is described as "happy," "content," "joyful," and "triumphant," while Jaguar is described as "bossy," "cranky," and "smug."

13. **A. Circle <u>two</u> features that show that "The Cricket and the Jaguar" is a folktale.**

a. It teaches a lesson.
b. It is passed down from generation to generation.
c. It is the true story of a person's life written by someone other than the subject.
d. It is set in an actual place and time in the past.

B. Why do most folktales end with the smaller/weaker character winning?

a. Because the smaller character is usually the strongest.

b. Because folktales often teach that intelligence, kindness, or courage can overcome strength.
c. Because the larger character always makes friends with everyone.
d. Because the weaker character has magical powers in every story.

14. Fill in the chart using your own words.

Plot Element	What Happens in the Story
Exposition	Setting + Characters Introduced Cricket chirps in the hot sun. Jaguar wants to sleep.
Rising Action	The conflict builds up. Jaguar threatens Cricket, but Cricket keeps chirping.
Climax	The Peak of the Problem Jaguar declares war on all crickets.
Falling Action	The Plan to Fight Cricket and the insects fight Jaguar and his allies.
Resolution	The Lesson Learnt The insects win, and Jaguar leaves defeated.

Selection 1

Unit 1 Week 1
Cow Music

Weekly Concept:
Perspectives

Essential Question:
How do new experiences offer new perspectives?

Crossing the Creek

Ever since Maricia could remember, she had been a shy girl. She would have been perfectly happy to spend the summer in her room reading mystery novels, but her dad insisted that she go to camp. Before she knew it, she had boarded a bus full of excited campers and was on her way to Lake Fraser. "How am I going to spend an entire week with kids I don't know?" she asked herself.

On the first day, Maricia and her bunkmates went on an early morning hike. Cara, their counselor, led them in a single-file line along a narrow, leafy trail. Maricia noticed that Amanda, the girl who was last in line, seemed even shyer than she did. In fact, Amanda hadn't uttered a word all day. 1

After about an hour, the hikers arrived at a wide creek. The only way to cross it was to walk across a wooden plank. Filled with doubt, Maricia paused at the edge of the rushing water. 2

But then she imagined walking across the balance beam in gymnastics class, and she realized that this might be similar. Holding out her arms to steady herself, she took a few steps, trying not to notice the icy water and slippery rocks below. Slowly and carefully, she made her way across. 3

"That wasn't so bad!" Maricia told herself. Then she realized that Amanda was still on the other side, looking frightened.

Usually, Maricia wouldn't feel comfortable giving other people advice, but not this time. The words flew out of her mouth before she could stop them. "I was scared too, but I just thought about being on the balance beam in gymnastics. It's basically the same thing. Try it!" Maricia encouraged.

Cautiously, Amanda put one foot on the plank and then hesitated. "Just a few more steps!" Maricia cheered, as Cara stood by to help. Amanda kept going, and seconds later she was by Maricia's side.

"That wasn't so bad, either," Maricia thought. It was funny how helping someone made her feel less shy. As she and Amanda raced to catch up with the others, Maricia realized she was looking forward to what the rest of the week had in store.

Listening Comprehension:

Crossing the Creek



Listen to the story, then answer the following questions.

1. **What is the genre of the text? Support your answer.**

   Realistic fiction- The story has realistic characters and setting. There is also dialogue between the characters.

2. **How can visualization help you understand what "single-file" means?**

   I imagined how all the hikers are walking behind one another, following behind Cara.

3. **What descriptive details can help you visualize the setting?**

   Details like "a narrow, leafy trail", "a wide creek", and "slippery rocks" help you imagine the forest, the rushing water, and the wooden plank crossing.

4. **How can visualizing help understand Maricia's feelings?**
   Maricia paused nervously at the rushing creek and then slowly stepped across while encouraging Amanda. This helps us understand how she felt scared at first, but grew braver and more confident.

5. **In what way did Maricia feel differently at the end compared to the beginning?**

   At first, she felt shy and worried, but at the end, she felt confident, happy to help others, and excited to be at camp.

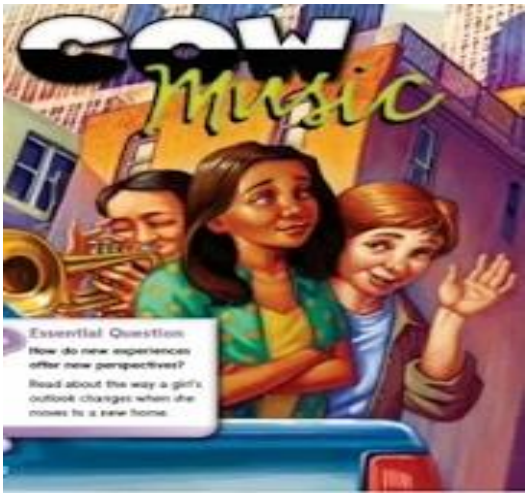
6. **Maricia changed her _____ about the camp after spending a week there.**

   a. perspective b. attitude c. manners d. story

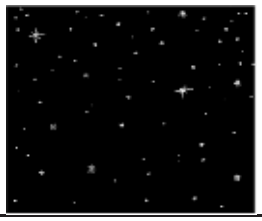
Wonders Vocabulary

Reading Selection: **Cow Music**

Word	Definition
threshold (n.)	an entrance or boundary
consolation (n.)	something that provides comfort or relief during a time of loss
glimmer (n.)	a faint idea or sign
heinous (adj.)	shockingly bad
indispensable (adj.)	necessary or essential
perception (n.)	the way you think about a situation or issue
phobic (adj.)	having a fear of something
sarcastic (adj.)	a person who uses sharp or ironic words to insult or hurt someone



A. Use the word chart to study this week's vocabulary words.

Word	Context Sentence	Illustration
consolation	The card gave the girl some consolation after she moved.	
glimmer	The stars glimmer in the night sky.	
sarcastic	His sarcastic words hurt his brother's feelings.	
threshold	I crossed the threshold and entered the classroom.	
phobic	The girl is phobicof chickens.	
heinous	Washing dishes can be a heinous job.	

B. <u>Directions: Fill in the blanks using the words below</u>.

consolation	glimmer	indispensable	perception
phobic	sarcastic	threshold	heinous

1. His decision to quit without notice was **heinous,** leaving the team in a difficult position.
2. She offered **consolation** to her friend after the tough news, knowing a kind word could make a difference.
3. A tiny **glimmer** of hope appeared on the horizon, suggesting things might still turn around.
4. In a crisis, a clear **perception** of the situation is crucial for effective decision-making.
5. He was often **sarcastic,** his dry wit sometimes misinterpreted by those who didn't know him well.
6. The old dog, though frail, was an **indispensable** part of their family.
7. She stood on the **threshold** of a new adventure, eager to see what lay ahead.
8. He was **phobic** about heights, even the sight of a tall building made him uneasy.

C. <u>Directions: Fill in the blanks using the words below</u>.

sarcastic	glimmer	indispensable	phobic
perception	threshold	consolation	heinous

1. There was a **glimmer** of happiness in her eyes that made me feel safe.
2. He had a kind of **sarcastic** expression on his face that hurt Maggie's feelings.
3. Mike is **phobic** about spiders.
4. Flowers were bought for the teacher as a **consolation** for the children's misbehaviour.
5. The young man committed a **heinous** crime.
6. Mr. Green is the most **indispensable** member of the team.
7. Jim crossed the **threshold** of his new villa.
8. Her **perception** about Tina has changed after getting to know her well.

A. <u>Directions: Read the passage, then answer the questions that follow.</u>

SMART START

Normally, the cafeteria was so noisy you couldn't hear a tray drop. But now, Alex's footsteps echoed across the huge room. There were a few other scattered students in the cafeteria, all avoiding eye contact with one another. The Dunce Convention, Alex thought, as his backpack landed with a loud **thud** on the table. He was here after school for his first sessionin "Smart Start," a program in which students received free tutoring in subjects that were difficult for them. Alex wondered whom the school thought they were fooling with their opposite-name trick. Smart Start meant "Stupid Forever."

Alex had been sentenced to Smart Start for math. His parents, already concerned about his grades, were even more agitated because the Statewide Math Aptitude Test was approaching. (Also oppositely named, Alex thought; in his case, it should be the Inaptitude Test.) Math had always been torture for Alex. For extra humiliation, his little sister had accelerated and was taking the same math subject as he, despite being almost two years younger.

Alex unearthed the crumpled registration form and quickly began to fidget with it, a nervous habit of his. Absentmindedly, he folded over the strip with his name on it repeatedly, scoring it until there was a sharp crease. Next, he tore the strip off, bracing the page against the edge of the table. What remained was a nearly perfect square—ideal for one of Alex's favorite pastimes: origami.

He began folding one of the common origami patterns, the bird base. Using his thumbnail to form the sharp creases, Alex created a triangle and added some petal folds. Soon, the bird base was complete, and he was partway into making the crane. So absorbed was he that he didn't hear the footsteps of the person approaching his table.

"You must be Alex. I'm Sophia," announced the girl, extending her hand. Startled, Alex quickly shoved his folded paper aside. Sophia continued, "I'm in eighth grade. Tell me a little bit about yourself. What do you like to do?"
Anything but math!" Alex replied.

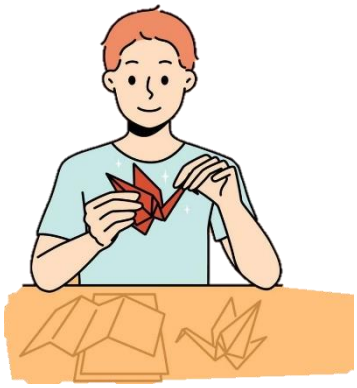
"Well, I guess that's why you're here," Sophia said with a laugh. "I used to hate math, too," She offered.

Alex recognized that Sophia was making an effort to put him at ease, so he granted her a quick smile. "What made you start to like it?" he asked politely.

"Believe it or not, I think it was the marching band. I realized that counting beats

and tracking measures is all about math. Hey, what's that you're hiding?" she teased, tugging at his folded form.

"It's nothing yet, but soon it will be," Alex explained. Quickly, Alex folded and creased, his hands awhirl. "Ta-da—a crane!" he proclaimed, presenting the transformed shape. "That's awesome," Sophia declared, staring intently at the origami folds. "Do you mind if I take it apart?" Alex shrugged, and Sophia carefully unfolded each step of the crane, leaving a geometric wonder of creases. Sophia looked excited about the wrinkled sheet, and Alex raised his eyebrows.



"Don't you see? What you have here is most of your math curriculum, right in front of you!" She flattened the paper out with the palm of her hand. "Do your first fold," she commanded, and Alex complied. "You began with a square and created two rectangles. And you have a fraction, too: one-half! Fold it again… and, magic, now you have four quarters." Sophia pointed to the top fold. "What fraction does this flap represent?"

"One quarter?" Alex responded.

"Duh! Obviously, right? Get out some more paper, and let's do some geometry!"

If math tutoring were going to be origami, Alex thought, maybe it would be a Smart Start after all.

B. <u>Directions: Answer the following questions.</u>

1. **A. Picture the cafeteria in mind. Mention three details from lines 1-4 that help you visualize how noisy and big it was?**

   It was normally very noisy that you couldn't hear a tray drop. Alex's footsteps echoed across the huge room.

   B. "Normally, the cafeteria was so noisy you couldn't hear a tray drop. But now, Alex's footsteps echoed across the huge room. "

   What's the author trying to show using this contrast?

   He is trying to show that the cafeteria, usually full of noise and students, now felt empty and lonely, which made Alex feel uncomfortable.

2. **Read this sentence from the passage.**

"The Dunce Convention, Alex thought, as his backpack landed with a loud **thud** on the table."

What does "thud" mean in the sentence above?

a. bang b. bug c. scream d. cry

3. **"Alex had been <u>sentenced</u> to Smart Start for math." How does the word choice of "sentenced" help you understand how Alex feels?**
It sounds like a punishment, which suggests that Alex feels trapped and unhappy about attending tutoring.

4. **Why does Alex refer to Smart Start as an "opposite-name trick"?**

He thinks the program is misleading. He feels embarrassed and uncomfortable because now everyone knows that he isn't good at math.

5. **What does Alex do just before he meets Sophia for the first time?**

He folds his registration paper into an origami crane.

6. **What character trait does Sophia show in:**
lines 25-27 She is friendly and caring because she introduces herself and tries to make Alex feel comfortable.
line 29 She is understanding and empathetic because she tells Alex that she used to hate math too.
lines 41 & 42 She is helpful and encouraging because she shows Alex how origami can help him understand math.

7. **What caused Alex to change his attitude about Smart Start by the end of the story?**

Sophia shows him that math could be connected to his favorite hobby. He realized that math might not be so bad after all.

8. **Infer the main theme and cite text evidence in support.**
Learning can become enjoyable when it connects to your interests. Text evidence: "If math tutoring were going to be origami, Alex thought, maybe it would be a Smart Start after all.

9. **What similarities and differences do you see between Alex's attitude at the beginning of the story and the end?**
At the beginning, Alex felt embarrassed and angry about going to Smart Start. He felt it was a punishment. At the end, he felt more positive because Sophia showed him math in a fun way through origami. The similarity is that Alex still doesn't love math, but the difference is that now he sees it can be interesting.

10. **Circle <u>two</u> features that show that "Smart Start" is realistic fiction.**

a. It focuses on a real person's important achievements in life.

b. It has dialogue that shows what the characters say.

c. It includes imaginary characters like talking animals.

d. It is centered around events and problems that real people experience.

A. Directions: Read each passage. Underline the context clues that help you figure out the meaning of the word in bold. Then write the word's meaning on the line.

1. Math had always been torture for Alex. For extra humiliation, his little sister had **accelerated** and was taking the same math subject as he, despite being almost two years younger.
advanced

2. Soon the bird base was complete, and he was partway into making the crane. So **absorbed** was he, that he didn't hear the footsteps of the person approaching his table.
involved

3. Alex recognized that Sophia was making an effort to put him at ease, so he **granted** her a quick smile. "What made you start to like it?" he asked politely.
gave

B. Directions: Use what you know about context clues to explain the following word in a sentence: pastime. Be sure to include context clues that explain the word's meaning.

When I'm not doing any schoolwork, my favorite pastime is drawing.

A. <u>Directions: Read the passage. Use the "visualize" strategy to help you form mental images as you read.</u>

The Fearsome Machine

"I will never ride in one of those fearsome machines!" Abraham declared crossly. Abraham was clearly **irked**, his bushy gray eyebrows lowering in an annoyed scowl as he looked up at his nephew. The two men were walking in an open field behind Abraham's farmhouse, enjoying the sunshine. The year was 1915, and the first automobile had just arrived in the town of Westbrook.



"It's called an automobile, Uncle Abraham," replied his nephew impatiently. "This is a new century. We've got to move with the times." Bob was a young man who seemed in perpetual motion, always walking or jogging from place to place and quite unable to sit still. This energy served him well. As the only doctor in Westbrook, he was frequently called out at all hours of the day and night. "Every time I go out on calls with the horse, I have to harness her and hitch her up to the buggy," Bob continued. "With the automobile, I will just crank it, start it up, and go!"

"Maybe you save a little time," Abraham allowed. "But what about the disadvantages? A horse is quiet. You don't wake up the whole town when you go out at night in your buggy. Those automobiles make a terrible racket! And a horse eats good hay and oats from the farm. You're going to have to buy gasoline to feed that new machine."

"But a horse has to eat every day, and I will only fill up the car when it runs out of gasoline," Bob replied. "Admit it, Uncle Abraham, you don't trust any novelty because you don't like things that haven't been around for a while."

A few days later, Abraham heard the unfamiliar clatter of a - machine outside the farmhouse. He ran out front in time to see Bob driving an automobile on the way to visit a patient. The young doctor was obviously elated with the new vehicle, a delighted grin lighting his face as he bounced excitedly in his seat.

Abraham, in contrast, was frowning as he grumbled. "Well, I was right about the noise!"

As the days went on, however, he found himself thinking about the Model T. It had been so strange, after all, to see something that looked so much like a carriage advancing without a horse to pull it! At last, he headed into Westbrook to visit Bob and the automobile.

When Abraham arrived, he found Bob and the automobile in the shed behind the house. The Model T's engine cover was open. Bob was frowning at the engine in puzzlement.

"Uncle Abraham, I'm glad you're here!" the young man called out. "You've got that wonderful talent for fixing things, and this engine doesn't seem to be working properly."

"And there's another difference between horses and engines— horses don't break down!" Abraham exclaimed triumphantly.

"Yes, but horses do get sick sometimes," said Bob. "And engines can be repaired, just as horses can recover from illnesses."

Abraham was forced to agree with this point, but before he could speak, his attention was drawn to the gleaming engine in front of him. "So how does this wondrous machine of yours work, anyway?" he asked. "Oh wait, I see..." His sentences broke into quiet mumbles as he became absorbed in studying the parts before him. Bob just smiled as he watched his uncle work on the engine.

After about an hour of tinkering, Abraham looked up. "I think I've got it now," he said happily. "Try cranking it." With a few pops and bangs, the engine sputtered to life. "Come on! Let's take this thing out for a ride!" Abraham exclaimed eagerly.

"But Uncle Abraham, I thought you'd never want to ride in my fearsome machine," teased Bob.

Abraham blushed and grumbled a bit. "Well, that was before I saw the engine," he admitted. "It's just so much fun to work on!"

And so, Abraham began to welcome progress with the zeal of an excited child opening birthday presents. "After all, this is a new century," he would tell anyone. "We've got to move with the times!"

B. <u>Directions: Answer the following questions</u>.

1. A. When and where does the story take place?

The story takes place in 1915, in the town of Westbrook, behind Abraham's farmhouse and later at Bob's house.

B. Why is the setting important to the story?

a. It explains why Abraham is excited about horses.
b. It helps readers understand why the automobile seems new and unusual.
c. It tells readers where Bob works.
d. It explains why the engine stopped working.

2. Read this sentence from the passage.

"Abraham was clearly irked, his bushy gray eyebrows lowering in an annoyed scowl as he looked up at his nephew."

What does "irked" mean in the sentence above?

a. angry b. frightened c. amused d. tired

3. Why do you think Abraham was so strongly against the automobile at the beginning of the story?

He thought that cars are not as reliable as horses, in addition to being noisy and expensive.

4. Read this sentence from the passage.

"And there's another difference between horses and engines— horses don't break down!" Abraham exclaimed triumphantly."

What does the word "triumphantly" most likely mean as used in the sentence?

a. with sadness b. with pride and joy c. with confusion d. with fear

5. Read the following figurative language on line 20. "You don't wake up the whole town when you go out at night in your buggy."

A. Identify the figurative language used.

Hyperbole

B. Explain it.

Abraham exaggerates that the car will wake up "the whole town" to show how loud the cars sound compared to horses.

6. Why did the author compare the engine to a sick horse in the conversations?

a. To entertain the readers.

b. To show how engines work.

c. To show the different opinions about new technology.

d. To explain how engines can be fixed.

7. Using details to support your answer, what can you infer about Bob's personality from the following lines?

- 7-16 He is always moving and wants to save time by using the automobile.
- 23-25 He is excited and happy about his new automobile.

- 39-49 He is interested in the new technology and believes that engines can be repaired.

8. What does Abraham mean when he says, “We’ve got to move with the times!”?

a. People should always keep using old ways.

b. People should stop using automobiles

c. People should use only horses for transportation.

d. People should accept and adapt to new ideas and inventions.

9. A. How does the narrator use both Abraham’s and Bob’s points of view to show the story’s main message?

The narrator shows that Abraham does not trust the new automobile, while Bob welcomes it. Later, Abraham learns about the automobile and changes his opinion. This shows that people can change their opinions when they learn about new ideas.

B. Which statement best expresses the main message of the story?

a. Horses are always better than automobiles.

b. Doctors should own automobiles to do their jobs.

c. People can change their opinions when they are willing to learn about new ideas.

d. New inventions are bad.

10. Based on the ending of the story, what do you think Abraham might say or do the next time a new invention comes to Westbrook?

He might be curious instead of refusing it right away. He may want to study how it works and even try it out, just like he did with the automobile.

11. Choose <u>two</u> features that show that "The Fearsome Machine" is historical fiction.

a. It has made-up characters.

b. It has talking animals.

c. It is fictional, but the historical details are accurate and believable.

d. It talks about the achievements of a real person.

A. <u>Directions: Read the passage, then answer the questions that follow.</u>

More than "Man's Best Friend"

"Not again!" Julia cried to her parents. They had just told her the family would be moving overseas to a foreign land, far from home. Julia knew that meant she would have to leave her dog behind.

Julia loved dogs because they were so devoted, always there when a person needed a friend. These were important qualities to Julia because her family's life never felt very stable. Since her father was in the army, they moved to a new army base every few years. She could take along her books and toys, but bringing her dog was out of the question.

As an adult, Julia settled in a bustling city. Her apartment was small, and she had no backyard. But she could not forget her fantasy about adopting a dog, so one day she finally gave in to her heart's desire. She brought home a beautiful black and tan German shepherd puppy named Lucy.



Julia spent so much time playing outside with Lucy that she soon decided to move to the country. The city was noisy and dirty, but the country was beautiful. Julia and Lucy loved the peacefulness of their new home, and Julia felt her dreams had come true.

One day, Julia saw a news story about a group of hikers who went missing in the mountains. The ski patrol searched for the hikers, and so did volunteers with search-and-rescue dogs.

From this story, Julia learned how search-and-rescue dogs are different from other dogs. The best search-and-rescue dogs are so filled with motivation that they are willing to work hard for a reward, like a toy or praise. To search-and-rescue dogs, looking for lost people was like playing a game. Julia thought of a game that Lucy enjoyed playing in which Julia hid a favorite toy and Lucy searched until she found it. Could Lucy be a natural search-and-rescue dog?

Soon, Julia began training with a group of dog handlers and their search-and-rescue dogs. Lucy's first task was to find a toy, and when she did, to let Julia know by barking. Later in the training, Lucy looked for a person who was hiding. Finally, Lucy looked for a person who was lying on the ground, pretending to be injured. With each successful find, Lucy received a chewy toy along with a hearty "Good dog!" Julia trained too, running, biking, and climbing, so she would be strong enough to keep up with Lucy.

Julia would never forget their first search-and-rescue mission. She received a phone call in the middle of the night. Three college students had gone hiking in the woods and had not come home. The woods were filled with caves, ravines, and other dangers. Julia and Lucy immediately hopped into the car.

At the site, Julia met up with her team and got her assignment. As the sun rose in the sky, she took Lucy down a path. Filled with anxiety and concern for the safety of the missing students, Julia called out their names. Lucy ran ahead, nose in the air, sniffing for the scent of humans. They spent hours along the trail, but when they came back to the meeting point, they learned that another team had found the hikers. “Good dog, Lucy,” Julia said. She was proud they had helped, even though she felt a little bit disappointed that she and Lucy had not found the students.

Julia and Lucy’s next opportunity to help came soon enough. One day, an earthquake shook the city in which Julia had once lived. Again, Julia and Lucy drove off and quickly met up with their team of search-and-rescue volunteers.

What Julia saw astonished her. Fire and smoke threatened to cover the city. Many people were missing or injured. Once emergency workers determined the city was safe, special rescue groups were allowed to begin their work. Lucy and Julia joined other trained volunteers to search the city blocks for people waiting for rescuers. Using her nose as a guide, Lucy led emergency workers to people stuck in the rubble. Julia felt honored to be involved in this serious business of saving lives. She enjoyed doing the job and, most importantly, helping those in need. She also knew that she and Lucy had found their calling in life, and that they would always be a part of a rescue team.

B. <u>Directions: Answer the following questions.</u>

1. Why wasn't Julia able to keep her dogs with her in her early years?
   Julia could not keep a dog because her father was in the army, and her family moved to a new army base every few years. It was difficult to take a dog with them.

2. What can we infer about Julia's personality based on her decision to adopt a dog, even though her apartment was small and in the city?
   Julia was loving, determined, and caring. She really wanted a dog and did not give up on her dream, even though she lived in a small apartment.

3. Why did Julia believe Lucy might be a natural search-and-rescue dog?
   Julia believed Lucy might be a natural search-and-rescue dog because Lucy loved playing a game in which Julia hid her favorite toy and Lucy searched until she found it.

4. Why do you think Julia felt disappointed when another team found the lost hikers, even though she and Lucy had done their best? (Refer to lines 38 to 44)
   Julia was disappointed because she wanted to find the missing hikers herself and help save them. Even though she and Lucy worked hard, they did not get the chance to find them.

5. Read the sentence from the passage.
   "Filled with **anxiety** and concern for the safety of the missing students, Julia called out their names."
   What does anxiety mean in the sentence above?
   a. anger b. confusion c. wonder d. worry

6. Read the sentence from the passage.
   "What Julia saw **astonished** her. Fire and smoke threatened to cover the city."
   What is an antonym for the word "astonished" in the sentence.
   a. surprised b. amazed c. shocked d. unimpressed

7. What does Julia's reaction to the earthquake rescue mission reveal about her character and sense of purpose? (Refer to the last paragraph)
   It shows that Julia is brave, caring, and dedicated to helping others. She feels honored to save people and is happy to do important work that helps those in need.

8. Why do you think Julia says that she and Lucy "found their calling in life"?
   She discovered her true purpose in life, which is helping others through rescue work.

9. A. How does the relationship between Julia and Lucy evolve throughout the story?

At first, Julia was seeking companionship. Over time, their bond deepened when Lucy became her partner in serious rescue work.

B. What does this say about the emotional connection between humans and animals?

Animals can be more than just pets. They can share deep trust and teamwork with humans.

10. Based on how Julia and Lucy handled their past missions, what do you think they might do in the future?

They will likely keep joining rescue missions, helping in emergencies like earthquakes, floods, or missing-person cases. They will continue serving their community as part of a rescue team.

Vocabulary for Writing

Prompt 1: Practicing sports is good for practicing your skills, or does it take up your free time? State both views.

Word / Expression	Definition
boost	to increase or improve something, making it stronger, better, or more effective
reduce	to make something smaller, less, or lower in amount, degree, or size.
expense	the amount of money needed to buy or do something
play a vital role	to have an important or essential part in a situation, process, or event.
opponents	people who disagree with, compete against, or fight against something or someone.
proponents	supporters, advocates
time-consuming	taking a lot of time to complete or do
physical exhaustion	extreme tiredness of the body, usually after a lot of physical activity, work, or exercise.
give it your all **(idiom)**	to try as hard as you can; to put in maximum effort.
push oneself too hard **(idiom)**	to make yourself do more than your body or mind can comfortably handle, often leading to stress, exhaustion, or injury

A. Directions: Fill in the blanks using the correct word or adjectival phrase from the box.

boost – reduce – time-consuming – expense – opponents – physical exhaustion

1. Preparing for the school play was time-consuming, so she had little time for homework.
2. After running for three hours without a break, he collapsed from physical exhaustion.
3. Planting more trees can reduce air pollution in the city.
4. Paying for the party decorations was a big expense for him this month.
5. A healthy diet can boost your immune system.
6. Some opponents argued that the new law would hurt small businesses.

B. Directions: Fill in the blanks using the correct expression or idiom from the box.

plays a vital role – push oneself too hard – give it her all- proponents

1. She decided to give it her all during the final match.
2. Tammy push herself too hard during training and ended up injuring her ankle.
3. Many proponents of recycling argue that it protects the environment.
4. Teamwork plays a vital role in completing large projects successfully.

C. Directions: Choose the correct answer.

1. Good communication skills _____ in building strong relationships.

   a. reduce b. proponents c. opponents d. play a vital role

2. Drinking enough water can _____ your energy and focus.

   a. boost b. give it your all c. expense d. opponents

3. The critics were _____ of the new strategy.

   a. opponents b. reduce c. expense d. increase productivity

4. Using public transport can _____ traffic congestion in cities.

   a. expense b. proponents c. reduce d. boost

5. The _____ of school uniforms believe that they help students focus on learning.

   a. reduce b. opponents c. expense d. proponents

6. He _____ during practice and ended up feeling exhausted.

   a. expense b. pushed himself too hard c. reduce d. boost

7. Adam decided to _____ during the exam preparation.

   a. proponents b. give it his all c. boost d. reduce

8. The soldiers endured days of _____ during their intense training exercises.

   a. expense b. opponents c. boost d. physical exhaustion

9. Writing a detailed research paper can be very _____.

   a. boost b. reduce c. proponents d. time-consuming

10. Buying a new laptop was a major _____ for her this month.

    a. expense b. give it his all c. boost d. physical exhaustion

D. <u>Directions: Write (T) for true sentences and (F) for the false ones</u>.

1. Eating lots of junk food can **boost** your health. (F)
2. Buying a car can be a huge **expense** for most families. (T)
3. Planting trees can **reduce** air pollution. (T)
4. After running the marathon, he felt no **physical exhaustion**. (F)
5. The sun **plays a vital role** in giving us heat and light. (T)
6. Preparing for the school festival was very **time-consuming**. (T)
7. **Proponents** remain neutral and do not support either side of an argument. (F)
8. You can **give it your all** by sleeping all day and doing nothing. (F)
9. Some people are **opponents** of unfair rules. (T)
10. She **pushed herself too hard** during practice and injured her shoulder. (T)

Prompt 2: Some believe that celebrating birthdays is beneficial, while others believe the opposite. State both views.

Word / Expression	Definition
pressure to impress	feeling stressed or anxious because you want others to like you or think highly of you.
create memories	to do things that will be remembered in the future; to make experiences worth recalling.
strengthen bonds	to improve and make relationships closer or stronger.
show appreciation	to express thanks or recognition for someone's actions or efforts.
exclusion	feeling left out or envious when others are included in something you are not
feel valued	to feel recognized, respected, and important to others.
cost an arm and a leg **(idiom)**	to be very expensive.
count your blessings **(idiom)**	to focus on and be thankful for the good things in your life.
owe someone a debt of gratitude **(idiom)**	to feel very thankful to someone because of their help or kindness.
a pain in the neck **(idiom)**	something or someone that is very annoying or troublesome.

A. Directions: Fill in the blanks using the given words and expressions.

exclusion – create memories – strengthen bonds – show appreciation – felt valued

1. A heartfelt thank-you note is a good way to show appreciation.
2. Traveling with friends helps create memories that last a lifetime.
3. Family dinners can strengthen bonds between relatives.
4. She felt valued when her boss recognized her hard work.
5. He felt sad because of his exclusion from the school trip.

B. Directions: Fill in the blanks using the given words and expressions.

pressure to impress – cost an arm and a leg – count your blessings – owe someone a debt of gratitude – a pain in the neck

1. I owe my teacher a debt of gratitude for helping me succeed.
2. She felt pressure to impress her teachers with a perfect science project.
3. Sometimes, dealing with a slow computer is really a pain in the neck.
4. Even during difficult times, it's important to count your blessings.
5. That luxury car cost an arm and a leg, but he bought it anyway.

C. Directions: Choose the correct answer.

1. The student experienced _____ when he was not invited to join the group project.

   a. feel valued
   b. exclusion
   c. count your blessings
   d. show appreciation

2. Birthday parties are a fun way to _____ with friends.

   a. owe them a debt of gratitude
   b. cost an arm and a leg
   b. create memories
   d. a pain in the neck

3. Complimenting someone can make them _____.

   a. exclusion
   b. cost an arm and a leg
   c. a pain in the neck
   d. feel valued

4. Spending quality time together can _____ in a family.

   a. strengthen bonds
   b. count your blessings
   c. cost an arm and a leg
   d. feel valued

5. A messy room can sometimes be _____ to clean.

a. count your blessings
b. pressure to impress
c. a pain in the neck
d. show appreciation

6. He felt _____ his teammates during the championship match

a. count your blessings
b. cost an arm and a leg
c. a pain in the neck
d. pressure to impress

7. That handbag _____, but she saved for months to buy it.

a. strengthen bonds
b. exclusion
c. cost an arm and a leg
d. show appreciation

8. Writing thank-you letters is a way to _____.

a. a pain in the neck
b. show appreciation
c. cost an arm and a leg
d. pressure to impress

9. After receiving help, I truly _____.

a. strengthen bonds
b. a pain in the neck
c. owe them a debt of gratitude
d. exclusion

10. Even small daily wins remind us to _____.

a. exclusion
b. a pain in the neck
c. count our blessings
d. cost an arm and a leg

D. <u>Directions: Write (T) for true sentences and (F) for the false ones</u>.

1. His **exclusion** from the team made him feel disappointed and lonely. (T)
2. She felt **pressure to impress** her guests by planning a perfect birthday party. (T)
3. Ignoring your friends always **strengthens bonds**. (F)
4. Family vacations can't help but **create memories** that last a lifetime. (T)
5. Writing a thank-you note is a way to **show appreciation**. (T)
6. Spending time with someone can make them **feel valued**. (T)
7. That luxury car **cost an arm and a leg**, but it was free. (F)
8. A broken chair is **a pain in the neck** to sit on. (T)
9. Helping someone in need can make you **owe them a debt of gratitude**. (F)
10. Complaining about everything is a good way to **count your blessings**. (F)